Yorick

written by:

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INT. THEATRE SEATS - NIGHT.

The audience is applauding a stage with no lights on. Act 4 of Hamlet has just concluded.

Two audience members sitting by each other talk quietly.

AUDIENCE MEMBER 1
What do you think so far?

AUDIENCE MEMBER 2
I'm really liking it, Ophelia is so good in this one.

AUDIENCE MEMBER 1
I was thinking the same thing. I remember last season she was Lady Macbeth in "Macbeth" and she was perfect.

AUDIENCE MEMBER 2
Jordan!

AUDIENCE MEMBER 1
What?

AUDIENCE MEMBER 2
Amateur. Don't say
(mouthing)
"Macbeth" in a theatre.

BOTH
Bad luck.

AUDIENCE MEMBER 1
My bad.

They laugh at the superstition.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

TESSA is at the control panel with a headset on. There are two other people in the box with her, KEITH and HANNAH.

TESSA
Alright everyone, Act 4 is up. Good work. We ready for Act 5? Everything in place?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

JOSH
(over coms)
We're all good on stage right.

JAN
(over coms)
All good on stage left.

TESSA
Actors in place?

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

JOSH is standing by a table of props. He looks at the line of actors, HAMLET, and HORATIO. They are doing quiet warmups to get themselves loose and ready for the scene.

JOSH
Ryan, you feeling better?

HAMLET
Oh, yeah. Anxiety's all gone.

JOSH
Took your medicine?

HAMLET
Threw up and then took my medicine.

Beat.

JOSH
But you're good?

HAMLET
Oh, I'm great.

JOSH
Perfect, and you told Grant that he doesn't need to fill in the rest of the night?

HAMLET
Yes.

JOSH
And he took it fine?

HAMLET
I think he's in the back rehearsing, so I guess he's fine.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

TESSA
Josh, Jesus, ready or not?

JOSH
(over coms)
We got our royals ready to go.

TESSA
Jan?

INT. STAGE LEFT - NIGHT

JAN is sitting on a chair next to OTHER and GRAVEDIGGER who are also doing quiet warmups.

JAN
We're good here.

TESSA
(over coms)
Perfect, send them out. Lights up.

Jan waves for Other and Gravedigger to go on. They walk on stage and start doing the scene.

There is a crunching over the coms.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

Tessa is confused by the sound.

TESSA
Josh, are you eating?

JOSH
(mouth full over coms)
Wha?

TESSA
Are you eating fucking chips?

JOSH
(over coms)
Why do you assume it's me?

TESSA
Because you left your channel open and
I know you and your hungry hippo ass.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

Josh is eating from a big bag of Dots pretzels.

JOSH
You shut up, all I've had time to eat the past three productions is go-gurts and if I eat another I'm going to turn into yogurt. I need nourishment.

INT. STAGE LEFT - NIGHT

Jan is looking at the prop table, taking everything into account. Something is missing.

TESSA
(over coms)
So naturally, chips. Not a sandwich or a salad. And not during intermission either.

JOSH
(over coms)
I wasn't hungry then.

TESSA
(over coms)
Of course you weren't.

JAN
Josh do you have Yorick on your side?

JOSH
(over coms)
What?

JAN
The skull, Yorick's skull,
(more)

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

JAN
(over coms)
do you have him on your side?

JOSH
Uh, no. He's on in this scene at mark 185. Gravedigger digs up a bunch of skulls and finds Yoricks and then Hamlet holds him and gives a big speech.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

INT. STAGE LEFT - NIGHT

JAN
Ok, but you had him on your side?

JOSH
(over coms)
I did, yeah.

JAN
So where is he?

JOSH
(over coms)
On stage.

JAN
(relieved)
Ok, so you got him on?

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

JOSH
Yeah. Well, no. Hannah put him on.

Beat.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

CLOSEUP ON HANNAH

Tessa and Keith turn to look at her. Hannah looks at them and shrugs.

Josh is still eating over coms.

TESSA
Josh. Hannah has been in the blackbox with us the whole show.

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

Josh walks to list of cast and crew and starts checking names.

JOSH
What? No, Hannah's prop master and stagehand.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

TESSA
(over coms)
Usually, yeah, but Gwen got sick and called in. So Hannah is filling in for Gwen up here and *you* are supposed to be filling in for Hannah.

Hannah is on the list and *prop master* is crossed out.

Josh's name on the list has *prop master 6/15* written in pen next to it.

JOSH
What the fuck?

TESSA
(over coms)
"What the fuck"? Why "what the fuck"?

JAN
(over coms)
Who's saying "what the fuck"? What's wrong? Are we good?

JOSH
Hold on.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

TESSA
No, not hold on!

Josh gets off coms.

Tessa groans in frustration.

HANNAH
What's happening?

TESSA
We might be just a little bit fucked.

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

Josh walks around backstage asking various stagehands if they took the skull. They all shake their heads.

JOSH
Jan, did anyone put it on from your end?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

INT. STAGE LEFT - NIGHT

JAN
I'm pretty damn sure they didn't. It wasn't over here to begin with.

JOSH
(over coms)
Shit. Ask the actors, please.

TESSA
(over coms)
Someone tell me what's happening.

JAN
Umm...
(more)

Jan gets up and starts walking to the other actors, asking them if they know. No one does.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

JAN
(over coms)
We don't have the skull

TESSA
Yorick's skull? The skull that's in this scene?

JAN
(over coms)
That's the one.

TESSA
It's not in the grave?

JAN
(over coms)
I don't think so.

TESSA
Who the hell has it?

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

JOSH
We're trying to find that out now.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

TESSA
(over coms)
Josh, this was your job. If you can't find it, it's on your ass.

JOSH
It'll be ok. It'll be fine. Don't we have another in the back?

Josh walks backstage and looks around.

People are sitting and eating food, other actors are hanging out on the sides getting ready.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

TESSA
No, Josh. We don't have a spare.

JOSH
(over coms)
But everyone has an understudy!

TESSA
Not the fucking prop!

INT. BACKSTAGE - NIGHT

Josh picks up a canteloup from the snack table.

JOSH
What about a melon, that could work, right?

TESSA
(over coms)
A melon? Did you say "A melon"?

Josh holds the canteloup up like the skull of Yorick.

JOSH
Yeah. I could see it.

Josh starts walking to stage right again.

TESSA
(over coms)
Find the skull! If I see a melon rolling on stage I will shove it inside you.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONOR WRAY

Josh quickly turns back around and sets the canteloup down.

JOSH
Understood. Jan? Anything?

Jan appears behind him and taps him on the shoulder.

Josh jumps, startled.

JAN
Josh.

JOSH
Why would you do that?

JAN
Josh, listen.

JOSH
Never do that again, I didn't hear you at all. Holy shit.

JAN
I think I know where it is.

JOSH
What?

JAN
The skull, I think I know where it is.

JOSH
WHAT?

JAN
I asked Betty who was hanging out with Jasmine in the makeup room and Jasmine overheard and said that she was talking to Evan who's filling in for Drew as the king during intermission and *he* said that he saw Grant in the green room rehearsing with it.

JOSH
That was so many names.

JAN
The understudy told me the other understudy has the skull.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

JOSH
So who has the skull?

JAN
Grant! He's in the green room, go get it! Hurry!

Josh runs to the green room.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

TESSA
Guys, if you're going to do something, do it quickly. We just hit mark 100, Hamlet's delivering the first big monologue. You've only got 85 marks left.

INT. GREENROOM - NIGHT

GRANT
Alas, poor Yorick! I knew him Horatio - a fellow of infinite jest, of most excellent fancy...

Josh bursts into the room.

JOSH
Grant, what the hell?!

CUT TO TESSA WHO PULLS OFF HER HEADPHONES BECAUSE OF THE SUDDEN YELLING.

GRANT
What?! I'm rehearsing!

JOSH
With the fucking skull we need to have on stage right now?!

GRANT
Well, don't you have another?

JOSH
Apparently not!

Josh swipes the skull from Grant.

GRANT
But I thought there was an understudy for everything.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONOR WRAY

JOSH
I thought so too!

Josh starts out of the room.

GRANT
I still need a prop to rehearse with!

JOSH
(calling back)
Use a melon!

Josh walks back to stage right.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

Tessa puts the headphones back on.

TESSA
Josh? Do we have it?

JOSH
(over coms)
We have it.

TESSA
Great.

JOSH
(over coms)
Yeah, Jan went through some weird web of conversation to figure out that Grant actually-

TESSA
Josh, I'm really happy for you but I don't give a singular fantastical fuck. Get the skull on stage, the Gravedigger needs it in the pit.

Beat.

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

Josh looks paralyzed. He doesn't know how to get it on stage.

TESSA
(over coms)
Josh? You hear me? We hit mark 145, we need that thing on stage now.

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

JOSH
I don't know how, how do I do...how do I do it without people noticing?

INT. STAGE LEFT - NIGHT

JAN
The fog! If you blast the fog machine on stage left and right for a minute you can roll it across to the gravedigger.

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

JOSH
It means a lot that you have that much faith in my bowling skills.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

Tessa presses a button and moves a dial on the control panel, more fog comes on stage.

TESSA
Ok we have the visual handled, there's still the problem with the sound of a plastic skull tumbling rapidly towards a hole that might be distracting.

JOSH
(over coms)
Mark 175! Up the thunder.

TESSA
What?

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

JOSH
Mark 175 - Gravedigger says: "*Why, sir, his hide is so tanned with his trade that he will keep out water a great while; and your water is a sore decayer of your whoreson dead body...*", then there's thunder and he mentions the skull of Yorick.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

TESSA
So make the thunder louder?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

JOSH
(over coms)
Exactly!

TESSA
On it. Get ready.

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

Josh lines up the shot.

He gets in position to roll the ball like a bowling ball.

JAN
(over coms)
Mark 160...Mark 165...
(more)

CLOSE UP ON TESSA'S FINGER HOVERING ABOVE A BUTTON.

JAN
(over coms)
Mark 170...

TESSA PUSHES THE BUTTON.

TESSA
Go.

Josh bowls the skull through the fog, passing by Hamlet's legs, and into the open grave in front of the Gravedigger who pauses in confusion but doesn't break character.

INT. STAGE - NIGHT

GRAVEDIGGER
A whoreson mad fellow's it was. Whose do you think it was?

HAMLET
Nay, I know not.

GRAVEDIGGER
A pestilence on him for a mad rogue! He poured a flagon of Rhenish on my head once. This same skull, sir, was, sir, Yorick's skull, the King's jester.

HAMLET
This?

WRITTEN WORK OF CONNOR WRAY

GRAVEDIGGER
E'en that.

HAMLET
Alas, poor Yorick! I knew him, Horatio-a fellow of infinite jest, of most excellent fancy. He hath bore me on his back a thousand times, and now how abhorred in my imagination it is! My gorge rises at it. Here hung those lips that I have kissed I know not how oft. Where be your gibes now? your gambols? your songs? your flashes of merriment that were wont to set the table on a roar? Not one now to mock your own grinning? Quite chapfallen? Now get you to my lady's chamber, and tell her, let her paint an inch thick, to this favor she must come. Make her laugh at that...

INT. STAGE RIGHT - NIGHT

Josh and the other stagehands are celebrating wildly without making a sound.

INT. STAGE LEFT - NIGHT

Jan is also celebrating with the stagehands on her side.

INT. BLACKBOX - NIGHT

Tessa has her head in her hands and is very stressed out. She shakes it off.

Keith and Hannah have their arms in the air like they had just made a goal.

TESSA
Everybody good?

JOSH
(over coms)
All good.

JAN
(over coms)
All good.

WRITTEN BY CONNOR WRAY

TESSA
Good. Let's get through the rest of this. Get ready to send on King and Queen Laertes, the doctor, and a very dead Ophelia. Coming up at mark 220...go.

THE END.